

Preston-Check — Sales Playbook

Outreach to first paying customer in 4 weeks

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Sales Playbook

This is the operator-only playbook for converting the first ~10 paying customers. Everything in this doc is opinionated; deviate when something obvious applies. The general shape is: 5 outbound conversations per week → 1-2 demos → 1 closed deal in the first month, ramping to 2-3 per month by month three.

Pre-flight checklist (before the first call)

Verify these are working — five-minute check, blocks all sales:

```
for u in https://preston-check.com/ \
    https://app.preston-check.com/ \
    https://app.preston-check.com/#/settings; do
    printf "%-50s " "$u"
    curl -so /dev/null -w "%{http_code}\n" "$u" --max-time 6
done

# Stripe Checkout reachability
curl -s -X POST 'https://preston-check-billing.preston-check-
edge.workers.dev/checkout' \
-H 'Content-Type: application/json' \
-d '{"plan": "pro_unlimited", "email": "test@example.com"}' \
| grep -q '"url"' && echo "checkout: OK" || echo "checkout: FAIL"

# Homebrew formula points at latest tag
brew info preston-check/preston-check/preston-check 2>/dev/null | grep version
```

All four should report green. If any fail, fix before reaching out.

Promo codes (live, ready to use)

Five codes in your Stripe account. Pick the right one for the conversation:

CODE	DISCOUNT	USE CASE	USES LEFT
<code>FOUNDING100</code>	100% off first year	The first customer ever — give it away to anchor the launch story	1
<code>CONFERENCE</code>	100% off first year	Booth / event giveaway, expires 14 days	5
<code>EARLY50</code>	50% off first year	Early adopter pricing for outbound (months 1-3)	20
<code>SOC2READY</code>	33% off first year	"We're prepping SOC 2" cold-email response	20
<code>PARTNER25</code>	25% off perpetually	Referral / partner program — cuts forever	50

Customer applies the code on the Stripe Checkout page (`+ Add promotion code` link near the price). All codes work for both Pro tiers.

To create more codes: use the Stripe dashboard → Products → Coupons.

Ideal customer profile

Don't sell to everyone. Three concentric circles:

Bullseye (highest conversion): - US/EU fintech with **5–50 engineers** - Currently preparing for **SOC 2 / PCI-DSS / MiCA / DORA audit** - Has a CTO or Head of Security who reads pull requests - Stack involves at least one of: Solidity, Java, TypeScript, Go (the four languages with deepest catalog coverage)

Adjacent (medium conversion): - Crypto custody / DeFi protocol with public smart contracts - Series A-C startup with active VC pressure on security - Compliance-led organization that's done one audit and is preparing the next

Long tail (low conversion, defer): - < 5 engineers (no time to integrate any tooling) - > 500 engineers (long enterprise sales cycle, not where to start) - Pre-seed (no budget yet, will pay later when revenue arrives) - Banks / FIs with mature internal AppSec teams (high friction; come back at year 2)

Outreach templates

Cold email — fintech founder

Subject: <Name>, 294 fintech-specific security checks for ~10 mins of your time

Hi <Name>,

I built Preston-Check for the gap I kept hitting at <fintech-vertical>: generic security scanners flag 50 issues per scan and 45 are noise.

It's 294 hand-curated checks scoped specifically to fintech compliance – PCI-DSS, MiCA, DORA, NYDFS, OWASP API + Smart Contract Top 10, FATF Travel Rule. Open-source under Apache 2.0. The catalog is built from real incident post-mortems (Wormhole, Cetus, Beanstalk Farms, the 21,201-call session-polling attack that named the project), not regex pulled from public repos.

Three install paths:

```
brew install preston-check/preston-check/preston-check
docker run --rm -v $(pwd):/src ghcr.io/preston-check/scan:latest
curl -fsSL https://get.preston-check.com/install.sh | sh
```

Free forever for the scanner. The SaaS tier (\$999/repo or \$4,999/year unlimited) adds branded compliance evidence bundles that go straight to your auditor.

Worth a 10-minute demo? I can show you a real findings report from a fintech codebase including the AI-generated patches.

– Preston (preston@preston-check.com)

Cold email — fintech CTO

Subject: Cutting your SOC 2 evidence-prep time by ~70%

<Name>,

Most pre-deployment scanners produce reports SOC 2 auditors won't accept without manual reformatting. Preston-Check ships compliance evidence bundles mapped directly to PCI-DSS / SOC 2 / ISO 27001 / MiCA / DORA control catalogs – the bundle IS the evidence document.

Open-source scanner (294 checks). Closed SaaS layer wraps the output as the auditor-ready PDF. \$4,999/year unlimited repos.

I've got 5 founding-customer slots at 50% off the first year. Code: EARLY50 on the Stripe checkout. 14-day refund-no-questions-asked.

Demo (10 min): <https://calendly.com/preston-check/intro>

Try it now: `brew install preston-check/preston-check/preston-check`

– Preston

Warm intro — referral

Subject: <Mutual contact> mentioned you might find this useful

<Name>,

<Mutual> mentioned you're <preparing for X audit / shipping a new fintech product / dealing with security tooling fatigue>. Preston-Check might help.

It's a fintech-narrow pre-deployment security scanner – 294 hand-curated checks scoped to PCI-DSS, MiCA, DORA, OWASP API + Smart Contract Top 10, FATF, etc. Open-source under Apache 2.0, scans run locally (no source code leaves your machine), AI-augmented findings include suggested patches.

Easy to try: ``brew install preston-check/preston-check/preston-check`` then run ``preston-check --high-and-up`` in any repo.

Happy to do a 15-min walk-through of the kind of findings + suggested patches it produces if useful. Otherwise enjoy.

– Preston

LinkedIn DM — security engineer

Hey <Name>, saw your post about <recent SOC 2 / MiCA / Solidity audit topic>. Built Preston-Check (preston-check.com) — 294 fintech-narrow security checks + AI auto-fix, open source. Worth a look if you're preparing for an audit.

Discovery call script

15-minute call. Four questions, in order. Each answer determines whether to proceed.

Q1 — context (2 min) > "Walk me through your current pre-deployment security setup. What scanners do you run, and what do you do with the output?"

Listen for: Snyk Code, Semgrep, GitHub Advanced Security, manual code review, nothing. Anyone running nothing → high-conversion. Anyone running 3+ tools → fatigue, our positioning works. Anyone running just GitHub Advanced Security → easy switch.

Q2 — compliance (3 min) > "When was your last SOC 2 / PCI-DSS audit and what's the next one?"

Listen for: actively preparing → highest urgency. Last one was rough → highest pain. Never had one → too early; defer 6 months.

Q3 — pain (5 min) > "What's the most painful part of your current security tooling?"

Listen for any of: - "False positives" → emphasize AI false-positive filter - "Auditors don't trust the output" → emphasize compliance evidence bundles - "Too noisy / too many alerts" → emphasize fintech-narrow curation - "Hard to integrate with our CI" → demo the GitHub Action right then - "Cost is too high" → segue into pricing tiers + early-adopter promo

Q4 — close (5 min) > "If I could show you a real Preston-Check report on your codebase right now, would that be useful?"

Three answers:

- **"Yes, let's do it"** → schedule a follow-up demo for tomorrow. Don't try to do it on this first call.
- **"Send me a link, I'll try it myself"** → send the install command + EARLY50 promo code. Follow up 48h later asking what they saw.
- **"Not now"** → ask "what would change that?" and respect the answer. Add to a 90-day follow-up list.

Don't pitch pricing on the first call unless they ask. Pricing is the fastest way to lose a deal that hasn't surfaced the value yet.

Demo recipe (15 min, after first call)

The wow-moment sequence in order. Don't deviate; this is what works.

Setup (90 sec) - Screen-share your terminal at any large fintech repo (Bloxcross, digital_escrow, or a public fintech project on GitHub) - Have `preston-check --version` ready to show v1.7.x - Have the customer portal `app.preston-check.com/#/findings` open in a tab - Have a real Stripe Checkout URL ready (use FOUNDING100 if it's the right close)

Act 1 — install + scan (3 min)

```
brew install preston-check/preston-check/preston-check
preston-check --high-and-up
```

Let it run. Talk while the output streams: explain the 294 checks, the catalog curation, the 1.3M traces it was validated against. By the time you're done explaining, the scan is done.

Act 2 — score-as-headline (1 min) The terminal output ends with a score and a letter grade. Stop. Read the grade aloud. *"This codebase is at A-. That's the top quartile of fintechs your size."*

Act 3 — the AI moat (3 min)

```
preston-check --ai-fix --high-and-up | head -100
```

Find one critical finding with a suggested patch. Read the patch aloud. *"This isn't just 'you have SQL injection at line 142.' It's the actual fix, ready to git apply. That's the difference."*

Act 4 — compliance evidence (3 min)

```
preston-check --framework "PCI-DSS" --report pci-evidence.md
```

Open the resulting PDF. Show the framework-citation column on every finding. *"This is what your auditor wants. Right now most tools produce JSON your auditor's intake person has to manually reformat. We produce the evidence bundle directly."*

Act 5 — pricing (3 min) - Free forever for the scanner - \$4,999/year unlimited repos for branded reports + multi-repo dashboard - 50% off first year via EARLY50 (or 100% off first year for founding customers via FOUNDING100) - 14-day refund window, no questions

Act 6 — close (1.5 min) > "Want me to send you the EARLY50 link now so you can play with it > on your team's repos?"

Send the Stripe Checkout URL. Stay on the call until they've clicked through and seen the dashboard if they're high-intent.

Objection handling

The eight most common objections and the one-line responses that work:

OBJECTION	RESPONSE
"We already use Snyk"	"Snyk is excellent for general-purpose. We're fintech-narrow — different cohort. Customers run both. Want to compare reports?"
"We don't have budget"	"Free tier is the same scanner — you only pay for the audit-ready packaging. Try the free version first."
"We don't want our code leaving our machines"	"It doesn't. Scans run locally. The opt-in telemetry is aggregate scores only, no source."
"Too many tools already"	"Replaces Semgrep + Snyk Code + a manual fintech-checklist spreadsheet for the 294 fintech-specific checks. Reduces your stack, doesn't add to it."
"We need SSO / SOC 2 / Enterprise features"	"All on the Enterprise tier — let's get on a call with sales@preston-check.com."
"Open source — what's your moat?"	"The catalog is curated, not crawled. AI auto-fix improves with scan volume. The annual State of Fintech Security report is the canonical industry benchmark in 2-3 years. Open source IS the funnel."
"We need a security review of your tool first"	"Read the source — it's all on GitHub. Apache 2.0. SECURITY.md has our disclosure policy. Happy to answer specific questions."
"Can we self-host?"	"Enterprise tier includes on-premise deployment. Pro is SaaS-only because the audit-package layer needs the dashboard."

First-customer playbook (after they pay)

Once a Stripe webhook fires for the first paying customer:

- Within 1 hour:** 1. Stripe email arrives confirming the subscription 2. Generate a license file:
`tools/issue-license.sh --customer <slug> --tier pro --expires +1y` 3. Email the customer:
- Welcome message - Attach the `.license` file - Install path reminder: `brew install preston-check/preston-check/preston-check` - License install location: `~/preston-check/license` - Quick-start command: `preston-check --high-and-up --report security-audit.md` - Direct link to schedule a 30-min onboarding call
- Within 7 days:** 4. Schedule and run a 30-min onboarding call 5. Walk through their first scan together 6. Identify their top three pain points; address what's actionable 7. Set expectations on AI augmentation (bring your own key) 8. Add them to the founding-customer Slack / email list
- Within 30 days:** 9. Check in: did they integrate into CI? See any value? 10. Ask for a written quote / testimonial if they're happy 11. Invite them to be cited in the State of Fintech Security 2026 report
- Within 90 days:** 12. Renewal-prep call: any change requests, anything they'd build differently 13. Discuss expansion (more repos, Enterprise tier, custom checks) 14. Ask for one referral

Metrics that matter (track in spreadsheet for now)

Forget complex CRM until you have 10+ customers:

Metric	Where it's tracked	Target
Outbound emails sent / week	Manual Google Sheet	25
Reply rate	same	> 8%
Discovery calls / week	Calendly + Sheet	3-5
Demo calls / week	Calendly + Sheet	1-3
Closed deals / month	Stripe dashboard	month 1: 1 / month 3: 3 / month 6: 5
Free-tier scan volume	D1 telemetry table	grow weekly
Free → Pro conversion	Stripe + telemetry repo_hash join	track from month 3

Replace the Google Sheet with the admin portal Sales tab once that ships with real data persistence (Q4 2026 per the build sequence).

What to NOT do in the first 90 days

- Build new product features in response to one customer's "would be nice"
- Hire a sales rep
- Sign up for HubSpot / Salesforce / a "sales-stack-of-the-week"
- Pursue Enterprise pipeline (those have 6-month sales cycles; you need cash and feedback faster than that)
- Run paid ads
- Pay for any "we'll generate leads for you" service
- Underprice — early-adopter pricing is 50% off, not 90%

The cheapest, fastest, highest-signal path is **20 personal cold emails to fintech CTOs in your network plus 5 discovery calls per week**. Two months of that produces enough conversation to validate or invalidate the entire thesis.

When to come back to this playbook

Re-read at: 5 closed customers, 25 closed customers, 100 closed customers. Each milestone is a different sales motion; this doc covers the first one.